MODULE 5: INTERPERSONAL COMMUNICATION
(CO: 6)

Complete Study Textbook, Professional Writing Guide & VIT FAT Question Bank

Aligned with Official VIT BAENG101 Course Page Syllabus, Question Bank, and Past FAT Papers

Scope of This Textbook (Official VIT Syllabus - All 6 Topics): (1) Interpersonal Communication dynamics, (2) Leadership Styles, (3) Belbin Team Roles, (4) Negotiation Skills, (5) Thomas-Kilmann Modes of Conflict Management, and (6) Writing a Winning Statement of Purpose (SOP).

1 VIT FAT Exam Blueprint & Master Frameworks

Module 5 carries **15 to 20 marks** in BAENG101 FAT:

1. **Belbin 9 Team Roles (10 Marks):** Explaining Action-oriented, People-oriented, and Thought-oriented roles, and why balanced engineering project teams need diverse role distribution.
2. **Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Modes (10 Marks):** The two-dimensional grid (Assertiveness vs. Cooperativeness): Competing, Collaborating, Compromising, Avoiding, and Accommodating.
3. **Statement of Purpose (SOP) Formulation (10 Marks):** Structure, hook, academic trajectory, research alignment, and common SOP drafting pitfalls.

Thomas-Kilmann Mode	Coordinates (Assertiveness / Cooperativeness)	Appropriate Workplace Situation
Competing	High Assertiveness, Low Cooperativeness (“My way”)	Emergency situations requiring decisive action; vital company survival issues.
Collaborating	High Assertiveness, High Cooperativeness (“Our way”)	Complex integrative solutions where both perspectives are too important to compromise.
Compromising	Moderate Assertiveness, Moderate Cooperativeness (“Halfway”)	Time-sensitive deadlocks where temporary expedient settlements are required.
Avoiding	Low Assertiveness, Low Cooperativeness (“No way”)	Trivial matters or when emotions run dangerously high and cooling off is essential.
Accommodating	Low Assertiveness, High Cooperativeness (“Your way”)	When realizing you are wrong, to preserve vital relational harmony for future collaboration.

2 Belbin Team Roles & Statement of Purpose (SOP)

2.1 Belbin 9 Team Roles

Developed by Dr. Meredith Belbin, high-performing engineering teams require nine complementary behavioral roles:

1. **Action-Oriented:** Shaper (drives progress under pressure), Implementer (turns ideas into practical executable workflows), Completer Finisher (meticulously checks for errors and quality).
2. **People-Oriented:** Coordinator (clarifies goals and delegates), Teamworker (builds team cohesion and mitigates friction), Resource Investigator (networks externally for opportunities).
3. **Thought-Oriented:** Plant (creative problem solver generating unorthodox ideas), Monitor Evaluator (logical, unemotional judge of ideas), Specialist (possesses deep technical domain expertise).

2.2 Statement of Purpose (SOP) Architecture

An SOP is a personal academic narrative for graduate admissions or research fellowships:

- **Paragraph 1 (The Hook & Motivation):** Specific triggering incident or engineering project that ignited your intellectual passion. Avoid generic childhood cliches.
- **Paragraph 2 & 3 (Academic & Technical Trajectory):** Key undergraduate achievements, capstone projects, publications, and specific technical competencies mastered.
- **Paragraph 4 (Why This University & Lab?):** Explicitly name faculty advisors, current lab research directions, and unique university equipment you intend to leverage.
- **Paragraph 5 (Long-Term Career Vision):** Clear 5-to-10-year trajectory following completion of the degree.